

Eugenia Menaguale

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Office Contact Information

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Department of Economics
Princeton University
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Graduate Studies

Princeton University *2019-present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics
Expected Completion Date: June 2026

REFERENCES

Professor Gianluca Violante
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Professor Stephen J. Redding
Department of Economics
Stanford University
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Professor Ezra Oberfield
Department of Economics
Cornell University
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Prior Education

Bocconi University *2015-2017*
M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences (ESS), *cum laude*

Bocconi University *2012-2015*
B.Sc. in International Economics, Management and Finance (BIEMF), *cum laude*

University of Pennsylvania, Wharton School *2015*
Visiting student

Fields

PRIMARY Macroeconomics, Firm Dynamics
SECONDARY International Trade

Job Market Paper

“Stellar Skills: Superstar Firms and the Specialization of Human Capital.” 2025. *(Presented at Princeton University, Federal Reserve Bank of New York)*

Technological change is the key driver of sustained economic growth, but new ideas can only transform production if the supply of tech-specific inputs supports their adoption. This paper studies how imperfect competition in markets for tech-specific capital shapes firms’ technology adoption and workers’ accumulation of specialized human capital. I develop a general equilibrium model in which dominant capital providers set rental rates and subsidize training in the skills required to operate their systems. When providers internalize their effect on the market for tech-specific labor, the specific-labor margin, they charge higher markups but also invest in expanding the supply of specialized skills. This creates a policy-relevant trade-off: market power raises misallocation yet can stimulate investment in high-quality training. Quantitative analyses show how the balance between these forces determines the direction of technological specialization and welfare. The results caution against viewing stronger competition as unambiguously welfare-improving, since market power can foster skill formation that supports adoption of superior technology. Empirically, I analyze a case study on the digital infrastructure industry. Using large-scale job posting microdata and developer surveys, I study the open source release of platform-specific software by a major supplier of cloud computing power. I observe patterns consistent with my theory of subsidies to skill acquisition costs: the release of specific software is associated with increased adoption by US employers of the complementary platform, but also a lowered wage premium for the associated specialized skills.

Working Papers

1. “Market Entry and Plant Location in Multiproduct Firms.” With Juanma Castro-Vincenzi, Eduardo Morales and Alejandro Sabal. 2024.
2. “Risk-based Organizational Choices.” 2021. *(Presented at Princeton University)*

Selected Work in Progress

1. “Product and Labor Market Power: Evidence from Firm-to-Firm Networks.” With Chiara Motta. 2025. *(Presented at Princeton University)*

Research Experience

2022	Research Assistant to Prof. G. Violante, Princeton
2021	Research Assistant to Prof. S. Redding, Princeton
2020	Research Assistant to Prof. E. Morales, Princeton
2018-2019	Research Assistant to Prof. G. Ottaviano and T. Monacelli, Bocconi
2018	Research Assistant to L. Laeven and O. Tristani, European Central Bank
2016, 2017	Visiting Student, I. Gasparini Institute of Economic Research, Bocconi

Professional Experience

2025	Federal Reserve Bank of New York (Summer PhD Fellow)
2022, 2023	Balyasny Asset Management (Research Consultant)
2021	Bank of Italy, Rome (Summer Intern)
2018	DG Research at European Central Bank, Frankfurt (Trainee)
2016	Pharo Management, London (Summer Research Analyst)

Other experience

2024	Princeton Women Talks (Organizer)
2013, 2014	Bocconi Students for Microfinance (President)

Teaching

<i>Princeton</i>	ECO 301: Intermediate Macroeconomics (TA, 2022-2024)
	ECO ESS: Economics Statistical Services Lab (Data Science Consultant, 2022-2024)
<i>Bocconi</i>	CLES/BESS cod. 30030: Macroeconomics and Economic Policy (TA, 2018-2019)
	BESS cod. 30443: International Macroeconomics (TA, 2018-2019)
	CLES/BESS cod. 30453 Macroeconomics (TA, 2018-2019)
	BIG cod. 30326: Macroeconomics (TA, 2018-2019)

Honors, Scholarships, Fellowships, and Grants

Louis A. Simpson Center Data Purchase Grant, Princeton University	2025
Ph.D. Research Fellowship, Federal Reserve Bank of New York	2025
International Economics Section Data Purchase Grant, Princeton University	2024
International Economics Section Summer Fellowship, Princeton University	2020-2024
Graduate Economics Fellowship, Princeton University	2019-2025
Bonaldo Stringher Scholarship (Ph.D. full tuition waiver), Bank of Italy	2019, 2020
Graduate Merit Award (M.Sc. full tuition waiver), Bocconi University	2017, 2018

Personal

Citizenship: Italian
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate)

Last updated: October 2025